Adding Fractions

Like fractions are fractions that have the same denominator. For example, $\frac{1}{8}$ and $\frac{3}{8}$ are like fractions. $\frac{1}{8}$ and $\frac{2}{4}$ are **unlike fractions** because they have different denominators.

To add like fractions, just add the numerators. The denominator remains the same.

$$\frac{1}{8} + \frac{3}{8} = \frac{4}{8} \leftarrow 1 + 3 = 4$$

$\frac{4}{8} = \frac{1}{2}$

The answer to an addition or subtraction problem may need to be simplified. Always write your answers in lowest terms. Change improper fractions to mixed numbers.

Example

Hide

$$\frac{5}{8} + \frac{4}{8}$$

Step 1

Add the numerators.

$$\frac{5}{8} + \frac{4}{8} \leftarrow 5 + 4 = 9$$

Step 2

Place the result over the denominator.

$$\frac{5}{8} + \frac{4}{8} = \frac{9}{8} \leftarrow 5 + 4 = 9$$

Step 3

Change to a mixed number if necessary.

$\frac{9}{8} = 1\frac{1}{8}$ $\quad 8\overline{)9}\ 1\text{R}1 \quad = 1\frac{1}{8}$

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Lesson 5: Operations with Fractions

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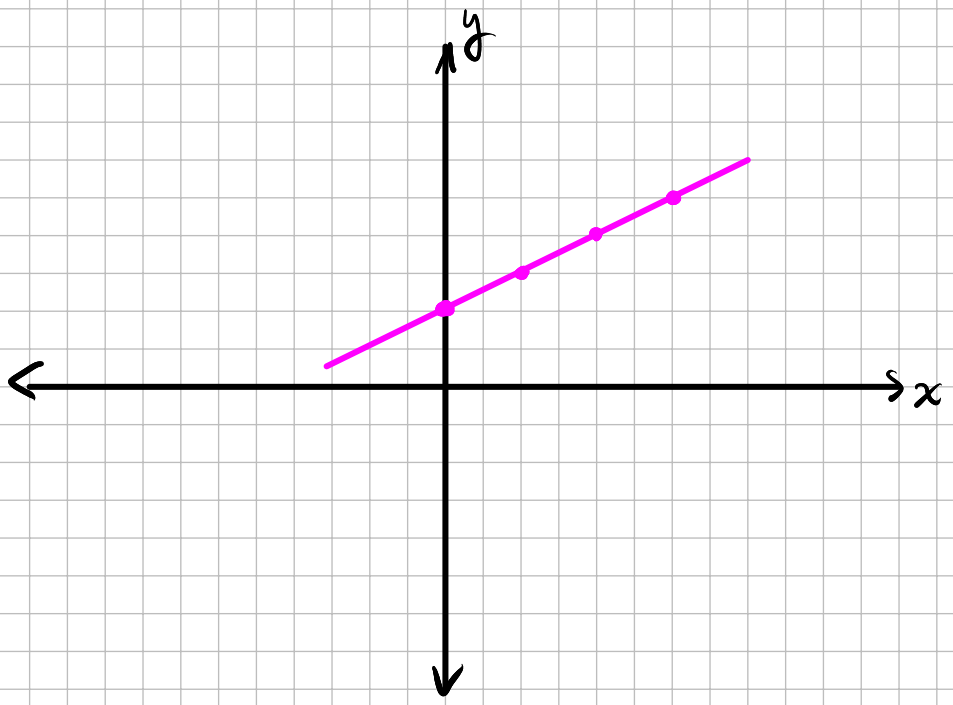
graph $x - 2y = -4$

rearrange until in the form

$y = mx + b$

m: slope

b: y-intercept



$x - 2y = -4$

$\frac{-2y}{-2} = \frac{-4 - x}{-2}$

$y = \frac{-4}{-2} + \frac{x}{2}$

$y = \frac{1}{2}x + 2$

slope $= \frac{1}{2}$

y-int.

$\therefore$ y-intercept $= 2$